



over the last two years. We have also included ESG parameters as part of our supplier due-diligence and will be extending this to the selection process as well. While optic fibres already have a lower carbon footprint than copper cables, we are looking to further reduce the plastic and carbon footprint of the products. Further, we prioritize circularity by ensuring diversion of waste from landfills, thereby also reducing harmful methane emissions.

In addition to this, we are undertaking afforestation, reforestation and biodiversity restoration programs in Pune and Aurangabad. Over the last two years, we have done **179,000 plantations**. Through our water program and convergence funding, we have covered 79 hectares of land with sustainable agricultural practices. Here, too, circularity forms an important component where plant and other organic waste is composted and utilized as manure. We strive to look at these programs holistically so that along with climate action, several other national and global concern areas like increasing poverty, decent work opportunities, gender equality and others are also addressed.

Having manufacturing facilities in the country, what measures is STL taking to ensure responsible operations?

Building business operations that are profitable and sustainable are at the heart of STL's corporate philosophy. We have high ESG goals for 2030 that include achieving net-zero emissions, water positivity, sustainable sourcing, **100% products covered under life-cycle assessments** and zero waste to landfill certification for 100% of manufacturing facilities.

Accordingly, we have put into place several measures over the years to ensure responsible operations. We have taken decisive steps to save energy, rationalize usage, explore alternative sources, and are working on reducing our Scope 1 (direct emissions from owned or controlled sources) and Scope 2 (indirect

emissions from the generation of purchased electricity, steam, heating and cooling consumed by a company) emissions. As we aim to become water positive across all our locations globally by 2030, we are ensuring sustainable management of the precious water resources through Reduction, Recycling, Reuse, and Replenishment. Several proactive initiatives have been taken over and above regulatory requirements. For example, we recycle and reuse waste water, thus ensuring zero liquid discharge outside our operational boundaries. In fact, in India all our plants are Zero Liquid Discharge certified.

Similarly, we have taken efforts to drive '**Zero Waste to Landfill**' across our Indian and Italian manufacturing units. This has helped us drive circularity of resources as waste which was earlier sent to landfills are now revenue generating streams. A comprehensive Quality, Environment, Health, and Safety framework in place ensures minimal to no accidents, spillage and reduces any negative environmental impact of our operations. We also train professionals in network deployment best practices to ensure infrastructure durability and minimize wear and tear, reducing replacement needs. We even work with industry partners to develop eco-friendly

packaging materials.

Further, STL follows the highest sourcing standards adhering to stringent international requirements such as Restriction of Hazardous Substances (RoHS) and Registration, Evaluation, Authorisation, and Restriction of Chemicals (REACH) regulations for its products.

The world is increasingly recognizing the challenges caused by our "take-make-dispose" approach. How is STL working towards a circular economy?

STL's Zero Waste to Landfill started with a vision to **recycle at least 99% of the waste** into the value chain. In 2020, we became the world's first optical fiber and cable manufacturer to be ZWL certified by Intertek for our manufacturing locations at Rakholi, Dadra (Silvassa), and Shendra, Waluj (Aurangabad). As a continuation of the policy and in line with our aspirations to have ZWL certification coverage for 100% of our global manufacturing facilities by 2030, we have currently launched an assessment for our Indian and Italy plants.

STL's ZWL philosophy pivots around the concept of a circular economy. This includes co-processing industrial waste in partnership with other players like cement companies to convert waste to energy. Safe disposal of official fiber cable and glass wastes was before this a persistent challenge for us. While this is one success story, there are many others. Segregation of waste to increase its recyclability and investments to reduce scrap are some other efforts that have helped us achieve Zero Waste to Landfills. These have helped us **divert over 180,000 MT of waste from landfills** over the last five years.

STL also drives a conscious attempt to promote the value of waste reduction and reuse among its employees as well. Waste buyers, too, are rigorously screened as per global standards to ensure responsible operations and waste traceability.

